Jeffrey Benson

Northern Virginia | linkedin.com/in/jeffreytbenson/ | bensonjt.github.io/profile | github.com/BensonJT

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Pulled into eight unfamiliar domains across thirty-one years: release management, ISO 9000 quality systems, capital and expense governance, IT asset management, privileged access security, fiber deployment, field workforce capacity, and applied AI. Whatever the assignment, what I found inside was a problem nobody owned and each one was measurably better on the way out. The skill was never the subject matter. It was the discipline to embed with the team that lives in the process, decompose what nobody had mapped, quantify what it actually cost, error-proof the steps that kept failing, and hand back an instrument the operators kept using after I left. Lean Six Sigma Black Belt who has built his own data pipelines since the first assignment, and who now works with AI as a partner: automating a team's recurring work, governing what the model produces before anyone trusts it, and teaching the people who own the work to run the tools themselves.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Process Excellence | Lean Six Sigma (DMAIC) | Operational Excellence | Process Architecture & Decomposition | Value Stream Analysis | Capacity & Demand Modeling | Business Case Development | Change Management (ADKAR) | Applied AI & Automation | Data Engineering (Python, SQL) | Data-Driven Decision Support | Root Cause Analysis | Executive Stakeholder Influence | Coaching & Mentoring | Error-Proofing & Control Plans | Workflow Automation | Applied AI & Agentic Workflows | Human-in-the-Loop AI Governance

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Claude & Claude Code (skills, subagents, MCP) | OpenAI Codex | Gemini Enterprise & custom assistants | LLM APIs & LLM-as-Judge Evaluation | Python | SQL (PostgreSQL, Oracle, DuckDB) | Grafana, Plotly, Streamlit | Slack & Google Workspace Workflow Automation | Smartsheet | Jira | SPC Control Charts, DPMO & Sigma Level

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Consultant | Cornerstone Solutions | Lovettsville, VA

December 2025 – Present

Principal of an independent consulting practice delivering working software under an AI-assisted operating model, owning the problem, the requirements and every review gate while an AI coding assistant drafts architecture and writes code. Shipped a multi-tenant SaaS product and a contracted client platform on that model, and left the client able to query the delivered database directly through an AI assistant rather than wait on reports.

Every stakeholder wanted the process in their own notation, and most clients had no baseline to prove improvement.

- Cut process model build from roughly 8 spreadsheet hours to 2 and went from 3 hand-drawn notations to 6 rendered from one captured model, each surfacing problems the others hide.

Building real software without an engineering team made the hard part trusting the code, not writing it.

- Shipped 18+ sprints of a multi-tenant SaaS product solo on Python, FastAPI, React and TypeScript over row-level-secured PostgreSQL, directing an AI assistant against written specifications.
- Governed AI-generated code with 31 architecture decision records, a three-layer automated test suite and a human sign-off gate on every stage of an autonomous build loop.
- Operationalized a stage execution guide assigning every sprint stage to an autonomous Claude Code build loop or an interactive session, with model and effort chosen per stage to spend tokens where judgment earned them.

An autonomous loop wrote both the code and its tests, so a green suite could not prove the code did what the spec meant.

- Proved an AI build loop's invariant tests could fail by planting each named defect: 4 of 13 slipped past a green suite, and after the fixes every one of 15 planted defects turned a test red.

An AI agent wrote code faster than one reviewer could read it, so defects could hide in plain sight.

- Closed a 253-finding audit of AI-written code: every open finding got a written disposition, 17 were parked with triggers, and all 194 fix-now items were fixed.

The client had no coding background, and no safe way to let his own AI agent touch the platform's data.

- Taught a client to work directly with Codex, from structuring his own research projects to querying the platform's database himself for the first time.
- Coached a client with no coding background into directing Codex well enough that he designed and shipped his own governed, read-only research bridge to a separate project.

An AI assistant would hand over a confident, plausible optimization that made the system slower.

- Measured every optimization an AI agent proposed instead of accepting it, using DMAIC to find the two root causes that governed runtime and cut a nightly pipeline from 7 hours to 4.

Scoring every news article with an LLM was affordable only on small models nobody had shown could match a frontier one.

- Qualified 4 candidate LLMs, local and via hosted APIs, against a 120-article reference set scored by two Claude raters, routing production to a free model at 93.3% sentiment agreement against an 85% bar.

Sr. Manager, Business Transformation (individual contributor) | Verizon | Ashburn, VA

Feb 2019 – Dec 2025

Served SVP-led organizations across Global Network & Technology as Business Transformation Partner and Black Belt, governing roughly 50 improvement initiatives to $455M at 128% of target while running DMAIC on the cross-organizational problems teams could not solve alone. Pivoted in 2023 to building the workforce capacity, forecasting and automation-foundation models that operating teams and finance depended on for accruals, and taught the team AI-assisted development and built the reporting assistants they used.

Teams were improving things everywhere, but improvement nobody documented or priced counted toward nothing.

- Formulated and defended a custom benefit model for every initiative served, translating operational KPIs into minutes, hours and wage rates or into contract rates, underwriting $455M at 128% of target.

Every initiative claimed savings, but nobody could say which dollars finance could book or whether they were arriving on schedule.

- Anchored hard savings to the funded budget, counting spend cut from the prior year's run rate and funded upward pressure no longer needed, so every hard dollar matched a budget line finance could remove.

A single governance report took eight hours to assemble before anyone could begin to read it.

- Slashed a financial governance report from eight manual hours to thirty minutes by coding the workflow, returning an estimated 200+ hours a year to every user of it.

Every Senior Manager tracked initiatives in a personal spreadsheet, so the Director team never saw its total work in one place.

- Scaled a personal spreadsheet into the Smartsheet initiative tracker the Director team adopted org-wide, giving 10 to 15 Senior Managers one view of backlog, active and closed work from 2021 to 2025.

Tickets and calls to the dispatch center were measured, but emailed requests could not be counted or timed, so demand stayed hidden.

- Moved an average of 5,200 monthly emailed requests into 36 external and 10 internal Slack workflows, making every request to the operations control center countable, routable and timed.

Automated dispatch kept getting worse the more business rules were added, because nobody governed the map underneath.

- Redesigned 41,326 zip codes into 521 contiguous work areas built around rivers, bridges and mountain passes, moving auto-dispatch from the 30-40% range to the 70-80% range nationally.
- Converted IT resistance by piloting the redesign in Virginia first, then co-authored the national rollout with field supervisors by framing it as shorter drive times rather than a data cleanup.

Capacity planning ran on averages, so Finance and Operations argued staffing from two different realities.

- Surfaced $18M to $22M in capacity variance and $3M to $4M in avoidable overtime with a Force-to-Load model covering a 1,000-person field force in the domestic United States, built in house for $1.5M less than the alternative.
- Iterated the capacity model across four versions in three years with the team that used it daily and cut runtime 25% with Gemini assisted consultation, delivering the insights faster.

Sales projections, vendor contract minimums and the budget were each defended separately and never reconciled.

- Overhauled the forecasting model and reworked its Grafana layer so the program office could enter cost assumptions and watch the five-year forecast recalculate live, retiring the spreadsheet what-ifs.

Generative AI arrived inside the company and most people had no idea what to do with it.

- Automated an Associate Director's weekly accomplishment reporting, classifying each item against EVP and SVP objectives, writing it in executive language, and flagging what merited escalation.
- Taught teammates to build their own AI assistants, spreading a practice that started as one status-reporting workflow into coding, debugging and executive communication across the team.

Manager, Business Transformation (individual contributor) | Verizon | Ashburn, VA

Jan 2013 – Jan 2019

Process excellence lead for IT operations; no direct reports. Led large cross-organizational process excellence programs to remove friction at the handoffs between teams and deliver SVP-driven strategic objectives.

Application teams waited more than seventeen weeks for infrastructure, and nobody had ever mapped why.

- Decomposed the asset lifecycle into 400 activities across 64 systems within two weeks, found 200 forms of TIMWOODS waste, and located the delay in 110 handoffs rather than in any individual step.
- Pre-wired the Work Out as a planned change step, meeting resistant stakeholders one-on-one beforehand to surface each one's own pain and invite them to co-design the fix rather than receive it.
- Cut asset acquisition cycle time from over 17 weeks to under three, an 82% reduction, by removing 43% of the critical path steps and significantly improving provisioning agility for application teams and accelerating capital value realization.

Five years after the business case was approved, nobody had established whether it was ever delivered.

- Closed the DMAIC Control phase at the five-year mark, returning to the same asset data to surface $61M realized against a $40M target (150% target attainment), then placed the control plan with the Director accountable below the two sponsoring SVPs.
- Drove unknown-reason defects in application-to-asset association from 30% to zero, because a five-year decommission count depends on both the mapping and the retirement dates being trustworthy.

The method worked on one lifecycle, and then people outside the program started asking to be taught it.

- Earned two consecutive features at Verizon's Lean Six Sigma Best Practice Conference, in 2013 for the SIPOC and ICOM tree-node model and in 2014 for the functional decomposition process map.

A security program was converting fifteen servers a week against twenty thousand, and every deadline was unreachable.

- Won SVP recognition at the 2018 IT Cloud and Platform Services Leadership Conference for turning around the Enterprise Access Management program across 30,000 Linux servers.

Nobody could say how many servers were in scope, because the count lived across fifteen systems no one had read together.

- Consolidated 15 disconnected sources into one master data set that put 30,000 servers in scope against the 20,000 planned, and scored every server nightly against 13 readiness checks, unlocking a 33x rise from 15 to 500+ migrations per week.

Migrations turned into hours of circular troubleshooting in night change windows, and two administrators carried it.

- Converted the migration from push to pull, so remediated and certified systems were pulled into the change window when ready instead of incompatible ones being pushed at a schedule.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Designer & Builder (AI-assisted personal systems) | Keystone and Requirements Fit Analyzer | Lovettsville, VA
December 2025 – Present

Unpaid proof-of-work and learning projects built with Claude Code (earlier Gemini CLI) as the agentic partner: Keystone, the vault of skills, scripts and integrations that gives Claude, Gemini and Copilot the same standard work, and three generations of a tool that measures how well requirement documents fit a verified evidence record, moving each deterministic step into code and reserving the model for judgment. Model output was reviewed by a human or measured against labeled data before it was trusted.

Every AI session started from zero, so rules won in earlier sessions were relearned and re-broken.

- Standardized recurring analysis work into a Claude Code skill router with 30+ reference procedures, so the same steps and guardrails applied whichever session ran them.
- Organized 106 skill files, 158,000 words, behind one instruction file, an index and 5 domain routers, so each AI session loads only the router and reference pages its task needs, whichever tool runs it.
- Captured 100+ rulings and corrections in persistent memory and vault skill files every session loads, consolidating them twice so a correction made once became a rule later sessions followed.

Drafts an AI wrote in one person's name sounded like an AI, and no style guide had been tested against none.

- Measured a personal AI voice guide blind against no guide on a 1-5 send-ready scale: version 1 lost, 2.5 to 4.0, and the revised guide with the author's own words scored 5.0 against 3.0.
- Turned the countable voice rules into a checker with no model call, failing em dashes and 21 banned phrases and capping 30 habit words, so human review went only to judgment calls.

Mail nobody triaged buried the few notices that needed action under job alerts and marketing.

- Split Gmail triage between an Apps Script that turned 49 sender rules into filters with a daily age-based sweep, and a scheduled Claude routine that proposes rules for new senders and never deletes or sends.

A fit model trained on a few hundred positives and seven audited misfires could not be tuned or honestly measured.

- Scored 2,973 documents with an LLM judge run as Claude Code subagents in 118 resumable batches, then retrained a TF-IDF fit model on the labels to an AUC of 0.973, ranking a strong fit above a poor one 97 times in 100.
- Pinpointed a rubric rule that made one whole category impossible to rate a top fit, 0 of 3,009, then split the LLM judge's grading into two lenses and recovered 255 misrated documents.
- Qualified a Claude Code-built LLM reviewer that demotes postings failing a hard requirement, admitting it only after it caught 21 of 23 human-gold fails against a 0.70 bar; a cheaper model failed eight rounds running.

Each new model layer could move the ranking, yet none had shown it beat what it replaced or agreed with blind human grades.

- Assessed an LLM reviewer as a gauge in a Lean Six Sigma measurement-system study: it passed repeatability, 1.6% flips over 230 pairs, and 5 of 5 injection tests but failed calibration, so it acts only where it passed.

A market analysis built from one pipeline run went stale as soon as the next run changed the numbers.

- Automated a 6-slide market analysis, its workbook and 5 charts to rebuild after every pipeline snapshot, each figure read from a database view and each headline turning neutral if its pattern flips.

Data Engineer & Analyst | Healthcare Claims Migration Validation | github.com/BensonJT/data_eng_exercise
February 2026

Applied Six Sigma measurement to a systems migration, converting field-level mismatch counts into DPMO, process yield and a sigma level a leadership team could read against a standard, then ranked the same findings by financial exposure so remediation could be sequenced by cost rather than by defect count. Published as a public repository.

A migration was ready to go live and nobody could say whether the new system agreed with the old one.

- Surfaced 4,777 missing claims, 159 missing beneficiaries and 82,699 payment discrepancies that a row-count reconciliation would have passed as clean.

Founder, Lead Architect & Full-Stack Developer | Benson Academy | Lovettsville, VA

May 2025 – Present

Built and shipped a production web application and an AI-assisted content system as an unpaid personal project, designing a human-in-the-loop pipeline that grounds generation in a curated knowledge base and gates publication behind mandatory human review. Volunteer work, and the proving ground for the AI-assisted build model later used on paid client engagements.

AI could produce the volume, but content that cannot tolerate one unverified claim put speed against accuracy.

- Designed a human-in-the-loop content pipeline grounding generation in a curated knowledge base and gating every lesson behind mandatory human review before publication.
- Slashed research-to-published cycle time roughly 80% with AI-assisted content workflows, using Lean analysis to standardize the lesson template so downstream assets generated reliably.

Generated narration could not be proofread like text, and the voice sometimes invented, dropped or repeated whole passages.

- Verified every AI-voiced narration and podcast part by transcribing it with a local Whisper model and diffing it against the approved script, catching invented speech, a dropped passage and a sentence read three times.

EARLY CAREER EXPERIENCE

Senior Member of Technical Staff | Verizon | Silver Spring, MD

Served directors and executive directors as an individual contributor across release management, quality systems, and capital and expense governance, entering each domain unfamiliar and standardizing what had been improvised.

Demand ran to $3B against a $2.2B budget, and every intervention had to be tracked against both.

- Reengineered the FP&A cycle with DMAIC, cutting cycle-time 70% and delivering output that would have taken 4.5 times the staff by hand, valued at $4.2M over more than six years.
- Partnered with FP&A to automate their month-end close in Access SQL, macros and Excel, embedding data-quality checks that cut the budget-versus-actual reconciliation from 3 days of hand-checking to 4 hours.

An SVP mandated ISO 9000 across the organization and nobody in it knew the standard, including me.

- Implemented ISO 9000 and CMM Level 2 across 24x7 technical operations, cutting critical system outages 80% and procedural errors 86%.
- Met all availability targets for the first time in the organization's history on the 24x7 operation the quality system governed.

Half the round-the-clock engineering team left every year, and nobody could say exactly why.

- Built the knowledge management system and document control process, and instituted the training framework for the 143 standard operating procedures that took attrition in a 24x7 technical operations team from 50% to 1%.

Every release manager planned their own way in their own spreadsheet, and what got missed was learned the hard way.

- Tripled annual release throughput from 665 to over 2,000 with no added headcount, on a template design Verizon was still patterning after twenty years later.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Master of Arts (M.A.) in Organizational Management, University of Phoenix
- Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Computer Systems & Psychology, Grove City College
- Master's Certificate (M.C.) in Project Management (PMBOK), George Washington University
- Lean Six Sigma Black Belt | Leland AI Builder Level 1
- Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) | ITIL v3 Foundations - Service Management

SECURITY ELIGIBILITY

- Inactive GSA Public Trust Suitability (est. 2021) | Inactive DoD Secret Clearance (est. 1991-1994)